Worksheet B: The Switchboard and Your Own Hypothesis

Name: _____ Date: _____

Task 2: Looking back at the switchboard

in class or homework

1. Write down the model your group built in round 1 and the number of trials that confirmed it.
2. Which *single* input would have put your model at greatest risk? Explain using Horwich's risk of refutation: a test confirms all the more strongly, the less likely its outcome would be without the model.
3. Name two auxiliary assumptions you made without saying so while exploring (Duhem–Quine: what is tested is always the model *together with* such assumptions).

Task 3: Null and alternative hypothesis for your research question

start in class, due by Unit 6

My research question (from Unit 2)	
Type of hypothesis (difference / association / change; directional?)	
H_1 (alternative hypothesis)	
H_0 (null hypothesis)	
Operationalisation: concept → measurement rule	
Population, conditions, time frame	
I reject H_1 if …	
Auxiliary assumptions I make	

Task 4: Diary of wonder

homework

Describe something that happened this week in which you (or someone else) merely confirmed an assumption instead of testing it. Which trial would really have put the assumption at risk?